MC 501 Weekly reading journal rubric

10 points. Due every Monday, 11:59 PM (remaining entries: October 19 and 26, November 2, 9, 16 and 23, December 7).

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 10. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Writing more than the word range asks for never costs points. Attempts are unlimited, so you can revise an early submission right up to the deadline.

- Length: 450 to 500 words per entry.
- Read the textbook with the Graduate edition toggle on, which shows a required graduate extension in every chapter. Each week also has an assigned peer-reviewed article, listed in the MC 501 schedule. An entry that addresses the chapter alone earns at most 7 of 10.
- Choose one of three thinking paths. The Connector links the reading to your project, other concepts, or real-world examples. The Troubleshooter documents a challenge you met and how you worked through it. The Critic asks critical questions, challenges assumptions, or explores implications.
- Each entry is scored out of 10. The three thinking paths (Connector, Troubleshooter, Critic) are equal; none scores higher than another.
- If AI shaped any work you submitted that week, the entry must say what you used it for and how you checked its output.

Weekly reading journal, 10 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Works with the assigned article 3 points	**3 points.** Works with a specific claim, method or finding from this week's assigned peer-reviewed article, named so a reader could find it.	**2 points.** Engages the article, but in general terms; a reader cannot tell which part you mean.	**1 point.** Mentions the article without using it; the entry would read the same without it.	**0 points.** Addresses the chapter only. This row is then 0, which is how a chapter-only entry reaches its maximum of 7 of 10.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Depth, through the path you chose 4 points	**4 points.** Works one or two ideas all the way through, using the chapter, its graduate extension and the article together. A Connector explains the link, a Troubleshooter shows the problem and how it was solved, a Critic asks the question and says why it matters.	**3 points.** Develops one idea, but stops before saying what follows from it.	**2 points.** Several ideas with a sentence or two each. An entry under 450 words usually lands here: the idea is named but not argued, so add what the reading claims, what that claim rests on, and where you agree or not.	**0 to 1 points.** No idea is developed past naming it, or the entry summarizes the readings.
Connection 3 points	**3 points.** Ties the readings to your own project or an earlier reading, and says what the tie shows.	**2 points.** Names a link to your project or an earlier reading, without saying what it shows.	**1 point.** The link is one that could be written without having done the reading.	**0 points.** No link to your project or an earlier reading.

Journal consistency

10 points. End of term. Scored once, at the end of the term, from the dates your entries came in.

Journal consistency, 10 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Entries across the term 10 points	**10 points.** All 14 entries submitted, each by its due date.	**8 to 9 points.** 12 or 13 entries submitted by their due dates.	**5 to 7 points.** 9 to 11 entries submitted by their due dates.	**0 to 4 points.** 8 or fewer entries submitted by their due dates.